영어 독해 · 빈칸 추론 · 심화 · 문제편

영어 · 독해 · 빈칸 추론 · 심화 · SKY 멘토 × AI 협업 출제

[심화] 1

In historical sciences such as geology or paleontology, the primary challenge is not the scarcity of remnants, but the ontological asymmetry between the past event and its present trace. A fossil or a rock layer is not a pristine capsule of a bygone epoch; rather, it is a highly filtered, distorted, and incomplete record shaped by intervening millennia of geological activity and taphonomic processes. To reconstruct the past, therefore, the scientist cannot simply read the record directly. Instead, they must construct a robust theory of the *transformation*—how the original state was systematically degraded into the current state. The core cognitive task is not merely cataloging what remains, but deciphering the systematic absences and distortions. In this sense, historical science operates under a unique epistemological constraint: the scientist's understanding of the past is inevitably mediated by their model of how that past was erased, meaning that they can reconstruct the bygone reality only to the extent that they can _____.

- ① decipher the physical laws governing the preservation of organic matter
- ② systematically model the selective filters of destructive history
- ③ isolate the original state from its contemporary environmental noise
- ④ prioritize direct empirical observation over theoretical extrapolations
- ⑤ establish a chronological sequence of events without subjective bias

[심화] 2

The human attentional system is often likened to a spotlight, illuminating specific features of the environment while leaving the rest in darkness. However, this metaphor obscures a more radical cognitive reality: attention does not merely select from a pre-existing pool of objective sensory data; rather, it actively participates in the construction of what we perceive as reality. By suppressing competing sensory inputs, the brain creates a highly coherent, yet radically simplified, simulation of the world. This selective inhibition is not a passive failure of processing capacity, but an active evolutionary strategy. Without it, the deluge of sensory information would overwhelm our decision-making faculties. Paradoxically, the very mechanism that enables us to navigate the world with precision is also what blinds us to its infinite complexity. Our perception of a stable, unified environment is, in fact, the product of a highly coordinated system of exclusion. In essence, the mind achieves functional clarity by _____.

- ① actively fabricating a cohesive narrative from chaotic sensory inputs
- ② systematically ignoring the vast majority of the external world
- ③ aligning immediate sensory data with long-term memory structures
- ④ expanding the capacity of working memory through chunking mechanisms
- ⑤ balancing bottom-up sensory impulses with top-down motor controls

[심화] 3

The optimism surrounding the transition to a digital economy often rests on the assumption that dematerialization—replacing physical goods with digital equivalents—inherently reduces environmental impact. However, this view overlooks a persistent economic phenomenon known as the rebound effect, or Jevons Paradox. As the efficiency of digital storage and data transmission improves, the cost of processing a single unit of information plummets. Instead of leading to a reduction in total resource consumption, this technological progress paradoxically drives an exponential increase in aggregate demand. Because it is cheaper and faster to generate, transmit, and store data, society finds novel, highly intensive ways to consume it—ranging from ultra-high-definition video streaming to energy-intensive artificial intelligence models. The efficiency gains, rather than conserving resources, serve as the catalyst for an unprecedented expansion of the digital infrastructure. Consequently, the drive for technological efficiency in the digital realm ultimately _____.

- ① bridges the digital divide between developed and developing nations
- ② renders physical resource conservation efforts entirely obsolete
- ③ amplifies the very ecological footprint it was promised to diminish
- ④ shifts the burden of environmental degradation from hardware to software
- ⑤ standardizes global data consumption patterns across different industries

[심화] 4

In human evolutionary history, cooperation among non-kin required mechanisms that could reliably detect and deter "free-riders"—individuals who reap the benefits of group cooperation without contributing to its costs. While direct reciprocity works in small groups, larger societies required more robust solutions. This is where arbitrary cultural rituals and taboos entered the evolutionary stage. Many of these practices—such as painful initiations, dietary restrictions, or elaborate dress codes—seem, from a purely utilitarian perspective, irrational or highly costly. However, their very costliness is the key to their evolutionary success. In the language of evolutionary biology, these rituals function as "honest signals" of group commitment. Because the costs of participating in these rituals are prohibitively high for outsiders or casual opportunists, they serve as a reliable barrier to entry. By demanding adherence to these arbitrary and expensive behaviors, a cooperative group can ensure that _____.

- ① individual autonomy is entirely subordinated to the collective will
- ② only those genuinely committed to the group's welfare are admitted
- ③ the economic utility of its members is maximized through division of labor
- ④ external threats are neutralized through symbolic warfare
- ⑤ cultural diversity is maintained within a highly standardized society

[심화] 5

One of the most intriguing paradoxes of aesthetic experience is our ability to feel genuine suspense and emotional intensity when engaging with familiar narrative works. When we re-watch a classic suspense film or re-read a tragic novel, we already know the outcome; the killer's identity, the tragic mistake, and the final resolution are firmly stored in our memory. Yet, our pulse still quickens, and our eyes still moisten. This phenomenon suggests that aesthetic engagement requires a highly specialized cognitive stance: a form of temporary, willful compartmentalization. To fully experience the narrative art, we do not simply retrieve our knowledge of the ending; rather, we actively bracket that knowledge, momentarily suppressing our foresight to align our immediate awareness with the temporal flow of the characters' unfolding present. In other words, the emotional efficacy of a known narrative depends on our capacity to _____.

- ① reconstruct the author's original historical and cultural context
- ② intellectually analyze the structural techniques of the medium
- ③ simulate a state of ignorance regarding the story's resolution
- ④ project our own personal memories onto the fictional characters
- ⑤ critically evaluate the moral decisions made by the protagonists

[심화] 6

The scientific enterprise thrives on institutionalized skepticism and the continuous refinement of hypotheses. Within the academic community, highlighting uncertainty, qualifying conclusions, and identifying areas for further research are signs of intellectual integrity and methodological rigor. However, when these internal communications are translated into the public sphere, a profound semiotic mismatch occurs. The lay public, accustomed to binary assertions and clear-cut directives from political and religious authorities, often interprets scientific nuance and conditional language not as evidence of rigor, but as a symptom of ignorance or division. This misinterpretation is frequently exploited by interest groups seeking to delay regulatory action. By amplifying the normal, healthy debates among scientists, these groups can manufacture the illusion of a fundamental disagreement where a robust consensus actually exists. In this way, the very virtues of scientific discourse—its openness, humility, and precision—are ironically transformed into _____.

- ① the primary driver of technological innovation in the private sector
- ② tools for political polarization and public policy paralysis
- ③ a universal language that transcends cultural and linguistic barriers
- ④ the basis for establishing absolute certainty in public health guidelines
- ⑤ mechanisms that protect minority scientific opinions from suppression

[심화] 7

Deliberative democracy, in its ideal form, relies on the existence of a public sphere where citizens are exposed to diverse viewpoints and forced to engage in the difficult work of mutual justification. This process of encountering alterity—views that challenge our own—is not merely an obstacle to be overcome; it is the generative friction that develops our capacity for democratic citizenship. It compels us to articulate our arguments in terms that others can accept, thereby cultivating a broader, more inclusive perspective. However, contemporary algorithmic curation on digital platforms systematically dismantles this generative friction. By predicting our preferences and feeding us content that conforms to our existing biases, these algorithms maximize engagement by minimizing cognitive discomfort. The result is the creation of hyper-personalized information ecosystems, or "echo chambers," that insulate us from opposing views. By eliminating the necessity of negotiating difference, these technological architectures ultimately _____.

- ① empower marginalized voices by providing alternative distribution channels
- ② atrophy the cognitive and communicative skills required for democratic self-governance
- ③ accelerate the speed of public consensus-building on crucial social issues
- ④ democratize access to high-quality information without institutional gatekeepers
- ⑤ balance the tension between individual liberty and collective security

[심화] 8

For decades, cognitive science operated under the "cognitive skin-bag" bias—the assumption that the human mind is entirely contained within the physical boundaries of the skull and skin. In this view, tools, technologies, and external representations are merely external stimuli or passive storage devices that the brain occasionally accesses. However, the paradigm of the extended mind challenges this internalist orthodoxy. It suggests that when we tightly couple our internal cognitive processes with external tools—such as a notebook for calculations, a map for navigation, or a smartphone for memory retrieval—these external systems do not merely assist our thinking; they *constitute* it. The mind is not a self-contained processor that occasionally uses scaffolds; rather, it is an opportunistic, distributed system that dynamically incorporates external elements into its functional architecture. From this perspective, drawing a sharp distinction between the internal brain and the external tool is an arbitrary biological prejudice, because _____.

- ① external tools are far more reliable and permanent than biological memories
- ② cognitive processing itself is a physically distributed phenomenon that spans both
- ③ human intelligence is solely determined by our evolutionary genetics
- ④ the human brain possesses an infinite capacity to process abstract information
- ⑤ artificial intelligence will eventually render biological brains obsolete

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